IWOWS

I Want Out of Welfare System

ORGANIZATION PROFILE | 2026

From Public Assistance to the True Middle Class.

A national economic-mobility initiative powered by Ideal Education - connecting education, paid work, employment, entrepreneurship, support, and community ownership.

LEARN EARN WORK BUILD OWN

NEW JERSEY ROOTS. NATIONAL VISION.

www.iwows.org

ideal EDUCATION
A NJ NON-PROFIT

A movement for people who want out of poverty — and into the middle class.

IWOWS — I Want Out of Welfare System — is a national economic-mobility initiative powered by Ideal Education, a New Jersey 501(c)(3) nonprofit. It connects education, paid work-based learning, employment, entrepreneurship, support services, and community ownership into one coordinated pathway.

AN IDEAL EDUCATION INITIATIVE

The Middle Class Movement

New Jersey's workforce system is a jigsaw puzzle — training providers, employers, colleges, county boards, corrections, and community organizations, each doing serious work, too often apart. Over ten years, Ideal Education has put those pieces together into one pathway: **education connected to paid work, work connected to careers, and careers connected to ownership.** The Middle Class Movement is how Ideal carries that model beyond New Jersey, so working families anywhere can move out of poverty and into the middle class.

Education → Income
Credentials paired with paid work from day one

Work → Careers
Employer-connected jobs, not just certificates

Careers → Ownership
Business creation and community equity

MISSION

Help individuals, families, and communities move from poverty and public dependency into middle-class stability through integrated pathways.

VISION

A nation where every person who wants out of the welfare system can access education, income, work experience, support, and ownership.

"Education must directly create economic transformation. It should not end with a certificate — it should lead to income, real work, employer connections, business creation, family stability, and ownership."

REN PARIKH | FOUNDER, IDEAL EDUCATION

BUILT OVER TIME

2012
Ideal Education incorporated as a NJ nonprofit

2016
Ideal Institute opens; first WFNJ & youth contracts

2025
10-year impact milestone; 1,350+ graduates

2026
IWOWS prepared for national replication

The system often manages poverty. We build pathways out of it.

Public assistance can be life-saving. But the long-term goal is stability, income, dignity, career growth, and ownership. IWOWS builds the missing bridge — without shaming recipients or pushing families off benefits before they are ready.

A bridge, not an identity

Public assistance supports families during hardship. Ideal creates a responsible path toward independence — no shame, no premature push off benefits.

Learn and earn together

Paid work-based learning lets participants build skills and income at the same time — roughly 10–25 supervised hours a week tied to their program of study.

We do what we teach

Training connects to real projects, social enterprises, apprenticeships, and employer relationships — real work for real customers.

WHO WE SERVE

Built for people who want a real path forward

- SNAP, TANF & public-benefit recipients
- ALICE and low-income households
- Unemployed & underemployed adults
- Disconnected youth & students
- Returning citizens & people in recovery
- Single parents & working families
- Immigrant & first-generation families
- Aspiring entrepreneurs & small businesses

INDIVIDUAL EMPOWERMENT PLAN

Every participant starts with a whole-person plan.

- ✓ Education & credentials
- ✓ Career goals & work history
- ✓ Income & benefits
- ✓ Transportation & childcare
- ✓ Housing & wellness
- ✓ Digital and reentry barriers
- ✓ Benefits-transition plan
- ✓ Middle-class capacity goals

Benefit cliffs are planned carefully — never triggered abruptly.

EVERY INITIATIVE CONNECTS TO THE SAME OUTCOME: MIDDLE-CLASS CAPACITY.

ONE PATHWAY ACROSS EVERY INITIATIVE

LEARN → EARN → WORK → BUILD → OWN

Learn. Earn. Work. Build. Own.

One coordinated pathway to mobility — not five disconnected programs.

01	L	LEARN	Academic, technical, digital, AI, career, financial, and entrepreneurial skills through K–12 CTE and adult workforce training.
02	E	EARN	Income through paid work-based learning — internships, apprenticeships, cooperative roles, and social-enterprise projects.
03	W	WORK	Transition into jobs, apprenticeships, contracts, freelance work, or career advancement with employer partners.
04	B	BUILD	Launch businesses, contractor pathways, digital ventures, food enterprises, and AI-enabled services.
05	O	OWN	Build ownership through entrepreneurship, cooperatives, shared services, and community assets.

A MODEL DESIGNED FOR REPLICATION

READINESS · DESIGN · PILOT · OWNERSHIP · EVALUATE & SCALE

"Participants should not have to choose between earning income and developing the skills required for long-term economic advancement."

THE CORE OPERATING PRINCIPLE OF PAID WORK-BASED LEARNING

One movement. 12 connected initiatives.

Every initiative is a spoke of one integrated system — powered by Ideal Education and pointed at the same goal: economic mobility.

EDUCATION & YOUTH

Ideal CTE Academy

K–12 career pathways, dual enrollment, and work-based learning.

Ideal Institute of Technology

Adult training, credentials, apprenticeships, and career mobility.

Youth Wellness & Career Services

Mentoring, paid experience, and whole-youth support.

EARN & BUILD

Ideal Social Enterprises

Paid work on real projects for real customers.

Entrepreneurship & E-Commerce

From job seekers to job creators and contractors.

Food Enterprise & Community Systems

Food access as training, business, and ownership.

COMMUNITY & SUPPORT

Center for Social Impact

Assessment, navigation, benefits planning, and barrier removal.

Atlantic City Community Cooperative

Food, vendors, youth employment, and community ownership.

Reentry & Recovery Pathways

Second chances through skills, work, and stability.

FUTURE & CAPACITY

Center for AI Technology

AI literacy, automation, workforce training, and business tools.

Green Workforce, Construction & Tiny Homes

Trades, green building, paid projects, and community improvement.

CTE Teacher & Instructor Pipeline

Preparing industry professionals to teach and mentor.

EVERY INITIATIVE CONNECTS TO THE SAME OUTCOME: MIDDLE-CLASS CAPACITY.

ONE PATHWAY ACROSS EVERY INITIATIVE

LEARN → EARN → WORK → BUILD → OWN

Ten years of implementation. Measurable proof.

Ideal Institute of Technology marked its 10-year milestone in 2025 — demonstrating that IWOWS is built on operating experience, not theory.

1,350+
Graduates empowered

$1M+
Paid through work-based learning

$1.7M+
Scholarships awarded

4,000+
Served through the Center for Social Impact

8+
Student-run and social enterprises

1,200+
Certifications issued annually

DOCUMENTED PUBLIC-FUNDING PERFORMANCE

$10.53M+

Documented public investment — including $9.83M+ in program grants and awards — with repeated renewals across **Atlantic County, the NJ Department of Labor & Workforce Development, the NJ Department of Corrections, and the NJ Economic Development Authority.**

$4.94M+	Nine documented Out-of-School Youth funding periods (Atlantic County / WIOA)
$1.5M	Green Workforce Training Grant Challenge — 126 participants served vs. a target of 100
$939K+	GAINS apprenticeship & PACE pre-apprenticeship, incl. an early award of 30 apprenticeships
$899,870	NJDOC NJLEAD reentry awards — four consecutive years, 2022–2025
$760K+	Three Work First New Jersey periods serving TANF & General Assistance participants
$599,454	NJBUILD construction-equity programs for women, minorities & minority veterans
$193,600	Opportunity Partnership training for dislocated workers
Up to $703K	NJEDA Local Property Acquisition grant — Atlantic City Community Cooperative

Accredited through 2032

Ten-year Middle States accreditation term through July 1, 2032 — curriculum, outcomes, and learner protections under external review.

Atlantic City Co-op

A 20,000-sq-ft community hub with a planned 5,000-sq-ft market, acquired with an NJEDA property grant of up to $703K.

College + AI pathways

Work-based college partnership with Centenary University and the Center for AI Technology, launched in 2025.

Impact figures reported by Ideal Institute of Technology, July 2025; funding record from Ideal Education past-performance documentation. "1,200+ certifications" is an annual figure, not a cumulative total.

Why Ideal earns the investment.

A practical framework that aligns public and philanthropic priorities while producing measurable economic mobility — not activity alone.

FIVE REASONS TO INVEST

01	**Systems model**	Education, work, support, entrepreneurship, and ownership in one pathway.
02	**Measurable outcomes**	Credentials, paid work, wages, placement, benefit transition, and enterprise.
03	**Multiple populations**	Youth, adults, ALICE households, returning citizens, entrepreneurs, and families.
04	**Designed to replicate**	Local chapters, school and workforce partnerships, employers, and cooperatives.
05	**Builds local capacity**	Institutions, enterprises, talent pipelines, platforms, and community assets.

INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITIES

- National Demonstration Fund
- Paid Work-Based Learning Fund
- Public Assistance Transition Fund
- Youth Career Pathway Fund
- Adult Workforce Mobility Fund
- AI & Digital Equity Fund
- Community Ownership Fund
- Evidence & Evaluation Fund

ALIGNED WITH PUBLIC PRIORITIES

TANF · SNAP E&T · WIOA · REGISTERED APPRENTICESHIP · CTE · REENTRY · DIGITAL EQUITY · GREEN WORKFORCE · ENTREPRENEURSHIP · COMMUNITY WEALTH

"Ideal is not proposing an untested workforce concept — it is building on ten years of implementation."

REQUEST A NATIONAL FUNDER OR POLICY BRIEFING **partnerships@iwows.org**

IWOWS

I Want Out of Welfare System

Help build the pathway.

Ideal has spent a decade building the components. IWOWS brings them together into a measurable pathway from poverty and public assistance to income, stability, entrepreneurship, ownership, and the middle class.

FUND

Invest in paid work, training, evidence, and community ownership.

PARTNER

Join as a public agency, employer, school, university, or nonprofit.

BRING IWOWS

Launch a demonstration or local chapter in your community.

"IWOWS is not starting with a theory. It is building on ten years of implementation."

SCAN TO EXPLORE IWOWS

www.iwows.org

partnerships@iwows.org